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1929, Delhi Assembly Bombs

The only reason that Bhagat Singh and his fellow conspirators were caught was because four months later the HSRA threw a couple of bombs before the legislature while it was in session. The irony is that Bhagat Singh may still not have been caught because originally it was B.K Sinha who was chosen to throw the bombs with B.K Dutt, but Sukhdev was unhappy with this decision and so Bhagat Singh replaced B.K. Sinha when Sukhdev goaded him into taking part.[1] Bhagat Singh, together with B.K. Dutt, was now set for the next escapade of the HSRA. The task at hand involved throwing two harmless smoke bombs in what is now the Indian Lok Sabha (i.e. Parliament), but was then the Central Legislative Assembly in New Delhi. This took place on 8 April 1929. The timing was propitious. The closing years of the tumultuous 1920s had climaxed with a series of nation-wide workers' strikes from 1927–1928, which had rocked the country. The government was determined to quash all dissent. It planned to pass two bills in Parliament, the Trades Dispute Bill and the Public Safety Bill. Public opposition to the bills was palpable. Ordinary people were all too aware of their needless oppression by the state. The government planned to play out a democratic charade of passing 'laws' which would oppress the workers even more. The restriction on the rights of ordinary citizens to protest would be passed as bills into law before their own representatives. For this reason, the HSRA was determined to prevent the passing of these two laws. The HSRA agreed that it would be Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt who would undertake the task. They would throw two home-made smoke bombs, accompanied by the showering of pamphlets making clear their objection to the new laws, just as they were being passed. They would then hand